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HONEYMOON

John McCone, the sixty-year-old silver-gray bespectacled CIA chief who had been the first to alert President Kennedy about the presence of Soviet surface-to-air missiles in Cuba in August, was spending the first weeks of September on the French Riviera. He missed the all-important meeting with the president on September 4, when Kennedy and his advisers decided what should be done about the news that McCone's suspicions had materialized and the Soviets had indeed put their SAMs on Cuba. McCone had very good reason to be away from Washington: he had just married the fifty-year-old Theiline Pigott, the widow of Paul Pigott, the wealthy president of the Pacific Car and Foundry Corporation, and was now on his honeymoon.[1]

While the French Riviera honeymoon was the beginning of a happy marriage that would last almost thirty years, and the weather was perfect for swimming and sunbathing, for McCone it was at times a torturous experience, as he had little influence on decisions then being taken in Washington on matters that deeply concerned him. As he read the cables he